Question ID 459dd6c5

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Area and volume	

ID: 459dd6c5

Triangles ABC and DEF are similar. Each side length of triangle ABC is 4 times the corresponding side length of triangle DEF. The area of triangle ABC is 270 square inches. What is the area, in square inches, of triangle DEF?

ID: 459dd6c5 Answer

Correct Answer:
135/8, 16.87, 16.88

Rationale

The correct answer is $\frac{135}{8}$. It's given that triangles ABC and DEF are similar and each side length of triangle ABC is 4 times the corresponding side length of triangle DEF. For two similar triangles, if each side length of the first triangle is k times the corresponding side length of the second triangle, then the area of the first triangle is k^2 times the area of the second triangle. Therefore, the area of triangle ABC is 4^2, or 16, times the area of triangle DEF. It's given that the area of triangle ABC is 270 square inches. Let a represent the area, in square inches, of triangle DEF. It follows that 270 is 16 times a, or $270 = 16a$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 16 yields $\frac{270}{16} = a$, which is equivalent to $\frac{135}{8} = a$. Thus, the area, in square inches, of triangle DEF is $\frac{135}{8}$. Note that 135/8, 16.87, and 16.88 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Question Difficulty:
Hard